

# Bazaar

We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

## Dell OptiPlex SX260

Sleek and powerful

The OptiPlex SX260 desktop computer from Dell has an ultra small form factor and is quite well-built. It sports a black body with a silver-grey front panel, which houses the power button and hard drive LED. The system comes with the option of mounting brackets for attaching the system underneath the table. This helps save desktop space considerably as there is only the flat panel monitor, keyboard and mouse on the desk.

This machine is primarily targeted at the corporate business user. It is powered by a Pentium 4 2.0 GHz processor that is upgradeable to 3.06 GHz and 256 MB DDR RAM that can be upgraded to 2 GB. The other goodies include Hitachi's 40 GB 5,400-rpm hard drive, a removable and hot-swappable floppy drive and 8x DVD-ROM

drive (which means that you can plug in the floppy drive or DVD-ROM drive without shutting down the machine), onboard sound, six USB ports and an Intel Pro 1000 Gigabit Ethernet card. It also has Intel Extreme Graphics, which is not only sufficient for most business applications such as 3dsmax and Autocad, but will also satisfy the casual gamers

who don't mind sacrificing on features to get higher frames per second.

The OptiPlex performed well for its configuration. It managed to encode a 50 MB WAV file to MP3 using Audio-Catalyst in just 29 seconds.

For video encoding, this system took 2 minutes 54 seconds, which is on par with any similarly configured system. However, in spite of having a 5,400-rpm hard drive with the 3.5-inch form factor used in laptops, it showed scores similar to that of a

front, the onboard 845 graphics core registered 96.1 fps at a resolution of 640x480, which puts it in league with the GeForce MX 400.

The system is also very easy to maintain and is high on security measures. It shows an alert message if the cover is removed, so you can check if any of the hardware has been tampered with. There is a single green knob at the back panel to open the cover of the PC to access the hard drive. This makes it easy for the user to upgrade the system memory, change the processor and even do some cleaning.

The PC comes complete with Windows XP (plus SP1), drivers CD, Restore CD, manual and a starter's guide. It also comes with two extra covers for the back panel to isolate the connectors from external shocks.

The machine is priced at Rs 1,10,000 which is justified given the performance, design and features that are packed into such a small form factor. The same machine, when



The back panel of the cabinet can be removed for easy access to the components



configured on Dell's US-based Web site, costs Rs 97,500. Its looks and features make the OptiPlex SX260 an attractive option for executives who would like a small, good-looking and yet powerful system capable of handling with flair the applications available today.

### SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium 4 2.0 GHz processor, 256 MB DDR RAM, Hitachi 40 GB 5,400-rpm hard drive, removable and hot swappable floppy drive and 8x DVD-ROM drive, onboard sound, six USB ports, Intel Pro 1000 Gigabit Ethernet card, Intel Extreme Graphics

**Price:** Rs 1,10,000  
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| Dell OptiPlex SX260 |        | A- |
|---------------------|--------|----|
| Performance         | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Build quality       | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Value for money     | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| Features            | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |
| OVERALL             | ▶▶▶▶▶▶ |    |